

Your First Customer on Hetzner

A beginner's step-by-step guide. No experience needed — just copy and paste.

What you'll have at the end: your medical-supply ERP running on the internet, with your first customer logged in at their own secure web address (e.g. `https://acme.example.com`).

Before you begin, get these 3 things:

1. A free **Hetzner** account · 2. A **domain name** (a web address — buy one for ~\$10/year at Namecheap or Cloudflare) · 3. About **1 hour**.

How to follow this guide. You'll type commands into a "terminal" — a black window where you type instructions. Copy each grey box, paste it in, and press **Enter**. Do them in order. Words in CAPITALS are things **you** must swap for your own details (see the table below). If anything fails, jump to **"If something goes wrong"** at the end.

When you see...	Replace it with...	Example
acme	Your customer's short name (lowercase, no spaces)	sudanmed
example.com	Your domain name	mycompany.com
YOUR_SERVER_IP	The number Hetzner gives your server	91.99.12.34
you@example.com	Your email address	me@gmail.com

1 Rent the computer (the "server")

A server is just a computer you rent that stays on 24/7 in a data centre.

Go to **console.hetzner.cloud**, sign up, and create a **New Project** called `medsupply`. Then click **Add Server** and choose:

- **Location:** Falkenstein or Helsinki (closest to Sudan = faster)
- **Image:** Ubuntu 24.04
- **Type:** **CPX31** (4 CPU / 8 GB / 160 GB, about €14/month) — plenty for your first customer
- **SSH Key:** click **Add SSH Key**. On your own laptop, open a terminal and run the line below, copy the whole result, and paste it into Hetzner:

```
# If it says "No such file", first run: ssh-keygen -t ed25519 (press Enter a few times)
cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub
```

Create the server, then **copy the IP address** Hetzner shows you. That's your `YOUR_SERVER_IP`.

2 Connect your domain (web address)

This tells the internet that your web address should lead to your new server.

Log in to where you bought your domain, find the **DNS** settings, and add one **A record**:

Type	Name	Value
A	acme	YOUR_SERVER_IP

This makes `acme.example.com` point at your server. It can take a few minutes to an hour to start working.

Important: do this now and let it settle. Step 8 (the security padlock) will fail if the web address isn't pointing at the server yet.

3 Log in to the server & lock the doors

We connect to the server, then close every entrance except the ones we need.

On your laptop terminal, connect to the server (type `yes` if it asks to trust it):

```
ssh root@YOUR_SERVER_IP
```

Now you're **on the server**. Run these to update it and switch on the firewall:

```
apt update && apt upgrade -y
apt install -y ufw fail2ban git
ufw allow 22 && ufw allow 80 && ufw allow 443
ufw --force enable
```

This blocks everything except logging in (22), and web traffic (80 and 443).

4 Install Docker (the engine)

Docker is the engine that runs the ERP. One command installs it.

```
curl -fsSL https://get.docker.com | sh
docker --version # should print a version number
```

5 Download the system

We copy your ERP code and add-ons onto the server.

```
git clone -b nile-ux-upgrade https://github.com/Wael9912/ephem_deployment_docker.git ephem-deploy
cd ephem-deploy
git clone -b v18.0.1.0.0 https://github.com/Wael9912/erpmedsupply-addons.git erpmedsupply-addons
git clone -b v18.0.2.5.1 https://github.com/Wael9912/odoo-nile-theme.git odoo-nile-theme
```

If it asks for a username and password: your code is private. Go to github.com/settings/tokens, create a token (classic, tick `repo`), then use your GitHub username and paste the token where it asks for the password.

6 Set your two passwords

The system needs two passwords: one for the database, one "master" password for managing it.

First, make two strong passwords — run this **twice** and keep both results somewhere safe:

```
openssl rand -base64 24
```

a) **The settings file.** Open it:

```
cp .env.example .env
nano .env
```

Find the line starting with `POSTGRES_PASSWORD=` and put your **first** password after the `=`. Save with **Ctrl+O** then **Enter**, and exit with **Ctrl+X**.

b) The Odoo config. Open it:

```
cp odoo.conf.prod odoo.conf
nano odoo.conf
```

Change these four lines, then save the same way (Ctrl+O, Enter, Ctrl+X):

```
admin_passwd = your_SECOND_password
db_password  = your_FIRST_password
dbfilter     = ^%d$
list_db      = False
```

The most common beginner mistake: `db_password` here must be **exactly the same** as `POSTGRES_PASSWORD` in the `.env` file. Copy-paste it to be sure.

c) Prepare the web server:

```
cp nginx/default.conf nginx/active.conf
```

7 Switch it on

```
docker compose up -d
docker compose ps    # everything should say "Up" (the database says "healthy")
```

The first time, this downloads about 1 GB — give it a couple of minutes.

8 Add the security padlock (HTTPS)

This gives your site a free certificate so the address starts with a secure `https://`. It renews itself forever.

```
bash scripts/ssl-setup.sh acme.example.com you@example.com
```

9 Create your customer

One command builds the customer's database and installs everything — inventory, purchasing, sales, accounting, and your Nile theme.

```
bash scripts/new-tenant.sh acme acme.example.com you@example.com --no-ssl
```

When it finishes, open **`https://acme.example.com`** in your browser, log in as `admin`, and **set a strong password right away**. 🎉 Your customer is live!

Now follow the **Customer Onboarding Checklist** (the other PDF) to set up their company, users, products, and so on.

10 Turn on backups

This is medical data — never run without backups. This makes an automatic copy every night.

```
crontab -e # if it asks which editor, choose nano (option 1)
```

Paste this line at the bottom, then save (Ctrl+O, Enter, Ctrl+X):

```
0 2 * * * cd /root/ephem-deploy && DB_NAME=acme bash scripts/backup_db.sh >>
backups/cron.log 2>&1
```

One more step soon: copy those backups **off** the server too (e.g. to a Hetzner Storage Box or Backblaze B2). A backup that only lives on the same server is lost if the server dies. Ask for help setting up `rclone` when you're ready.

If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
The website won't open	Run <code>docker compose ps</code> , then <code>docker compose logs --tail=30 odoo</code> to see the error
The padlock (Step 8) failed	Your domain isn't pointing yet. Run <code>dig +short acme.example.com</code> — if it doesn't show your server IP, wait and try Step 8 again
"Database not found"	Normal until Step 9 finishes. After that, refresh the page
Login or database errors	The two passwords don't match. Re-check Step 6: <code>db_password</code> = <code>POSTGRES_PASSWORD</code>

Adding your next customer (later)

Much quicker — just two things: add a new DNS A record (Step 2) for the new name, then run one command:

```
bash scripts/new-tenant.sh beta beta.example.com you@example.com
```

That one command handles the database, the security padlock, and the routing all at once.